Imagine a case that involves an ethical decision that a software developer has to make. You need to:

1) Describe the situation in detail
2) Formulate the ethical dilemma as a question
3) Give a solution/answer to the ethical dilemma

Ethical Case: The Biased Hiring Algorithm

1. You are a software developer working on an AI-powered resume-screening tool for a major client. During validation testing, you discover that the algorithm consistently ranks applicants with "ethnic-sounding" names lower than identical resumes using more "traditional" names. This indicates that the model has learned discriminatory patterns from historical hiring data. When you raise the concern, your team lead dismisses it, saying that fixing the issue would require retraining the entire model and delaying the already-late project. They insist on deploying the system as is.
2. Should you allow the biased hiring algorithm to be deployed on schedule, knowing it will unfairly disadvantage certain candidates, or should you insist on addressing the bias, even if it delays the project and conflicts with your team lead's instructions?
3. You should not approve deployment of the biased algorithm. Allowing it to go live would violate ethical responsibilities related to fairness, reliability, and quality in the client-producer relationship. It would also risk real-world harm by reinforcing discrimination and could create long-term legal, social, and reputational consequences for both your company and the client. The ethical action is to document the bias clearly, present the risks to leadership, and recommend retraining or redesigning the model before release. Even if this delays the project, preventing unfair discrimination and ensuring responsible algorithmic behavior must take priority.